Ice Rumble

WORKING TITLE

A LAN party game for 2–4 players: short physics mini-games, one shared scoreboard.

MASS KNOCKOUT

ICE RACE

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Concept render, AI-generated. Not gameplay.

A *LAN party game* made of short physics mini-games

PLAYERS

2–4 people in one room, each on their own PC. One PC hosts; the others join over the local network. No internet, no accounts.

SESSION

A playlist of short mini-games. Placement in each round earns points; one scoreboard runs across the whole session.

CHARACTERS

Everyone plays the same cube character, in one of four colours, with the same controls in every mini-game.

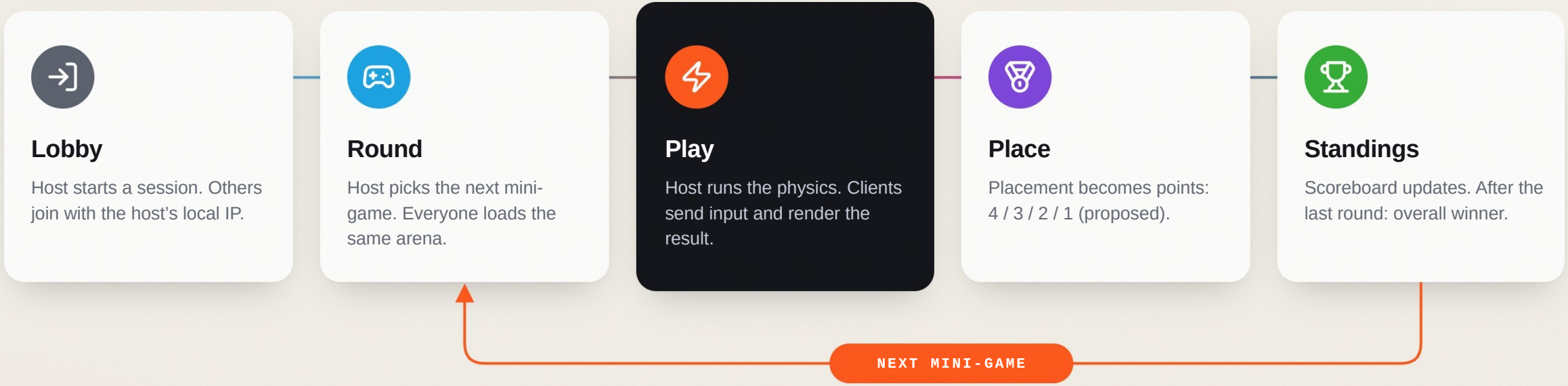
MVP SCOPE

Two mini-games, Mass Knockout and Ice Race, on one shared Unity core.



FIG. 1 — End of a round: placement decides points. Concept render, AI-generated.

How a session runs: *lobby, rounds, standings*



BETWEEN ROUNDS

Points

The only thing that accumulates across the session.

Catch-up scoring

Last round's winner earns slightly fewer points next round; last place earns slightly more. Nobody drops out of the race before the final.

Nothing physical

Mass and position reset every round, so one bad round does not snowball.

Mass is your *health*, your *ammo* and your *weight*



Shoot

A cube spits out a piece of its own body. Every shot makes it smaller, hit or miss.

Hit

The target loses mass on impact and is pushed back along the line of the shot.

Fall

Less mass means the same hit pushes further. Off the edge is a knockout.

FIG. 2 — Three moments of one exchange in Mass Knockout. Concept render, AI-generated. Not gameplay.

Why *both* the shooter and the target lose mass

IF ONLY THE SHOOTER PAID

Shooting is pure loss. The best play is to never shoot.

Players wait for others to weaken each other.

× REWARDS HIDING

IF ONLY THE TARGET PAID

Shooting is free. The best play is to shoot nonstop.

Aim stops mattering; volume wins.

× REWARDS SPAM

BOTH PAY — OUR RULE

Every shot is a trade. A miss costs only you.

A hit should take more from the target than the shot cost the shooter.

✓ REWARDS AIM AND TIMING

Spending mass only pays off when the shot lands, so *accuracy becomes the skill.*

Exact costs are tuning values. We fix them in playtests, not on paper.

Can a player win by *never shooting?*

THE RISK

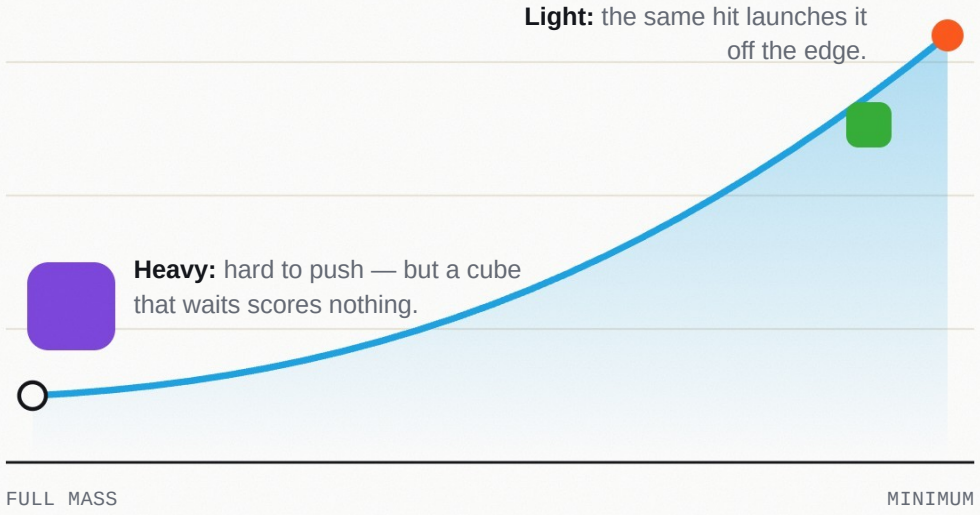
A cube that never shoots keeps its mass, so it stays heavy and hard to push. If the last cube standing won, waiting could be the best strategy.

OUR ANSWER: SCORE KNOCKOUTS, NOT SURVIVAL

- **Points come from knockouts.** A cube that never shoots scores nothing, however heavy it is.
- **Respawn at full mass.** A knocked-out cube returns after a short delay, so falling behind does not snowball.
- **Short round timer.** Waiting out the clock earns no points.

Fallback if playtests still show stalling: a shrinking arena, or letting cubes re-absorb spent globs.

SAME HIT, LESS MASS, MORE KNOCKBACK



Shape only — values come from tuning. Mass decreases from left to right.

Mass *Knockout*

GOAL

Knock other cubes off the floating platform.

CONTROLS

Move, aim, spit. A short cooldown between shots.

SCORING

The knockout goes to the last cube that hit the one that fell. Most knockouts at the timer wins.

RESPAWN

After a short delay, at full mass.

ARENA

One flat square platform. Open edges, no walls.



FIG. 3 — Orange spits a piece of itself; Cyan is hit near the edge. Concept render, AI-generated.

06 — MINI-GAME 2

Ice *Race*

GOAL

Finish the laps first on a floating ice track.

CONTROLS

Steering changes acceleration, not velocity. Braking restores grip.

SKILL

Low sideways grip: carry speed through corners without sliding off.

FALLS

Respawn at the last checkpoint. You lose time, not the race.

PLACEMENT

Finish order; unfinished players ranked by progress.



FIG. 4 — Racing a floating ice track. Concept render, AI-generated.

One shared core; *each mini-game plugs into it*

MINI-GAMES

Mass Knockout
mass · spit projectile · knockback

Ice Race
ice movement · track · checkpoints

MINI-GAME CONTRACT

`Setup(players) → Run() → Results(): placement`

SHARED GAMEPLAY

Character | Camera | Round state | Scoreboard | Lobby & UI

NETWORK

Host-authoritative LAN · Unity Netcode for GameObjects (candidate)

ENGINE

Unity · built-in rigidbody physics

Reuse

A new mini-game is new rules plus one arena. Character, camera, network and scores already exist.

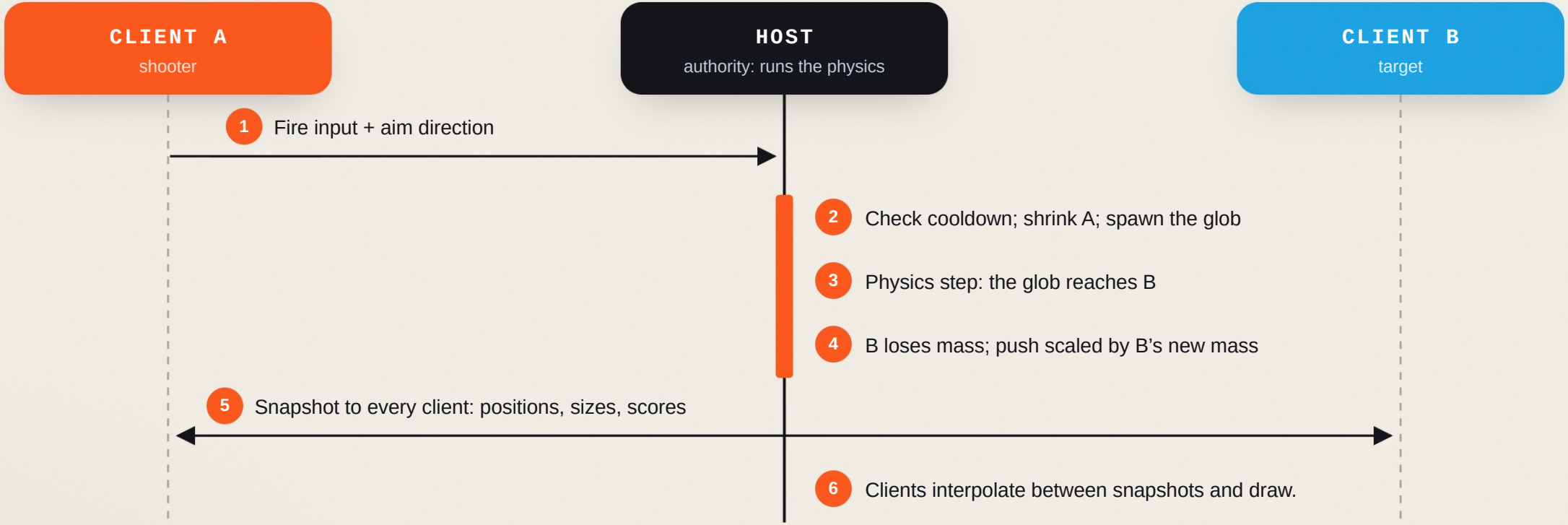
Per-game physics

Each mini-game sets its own profile: low grip on ice, firm grip in Knockout.

One truth

Everything that decides a result runs on the host, so every screen agrees.

One throw over the LAN, *step by step*



Your own movement is predicted locally so it feels instant. Hits, mass changes and knockouts are decided only on the host. Main risk: smooth physics on clients; LAN latency is low, and we tune the snapshot rate.

Same rules, *different builds*



FIG. 5 — Heavy, balanced and light builds of the same character. Concept render, AI-generated.

Because mass is also ammunition, a build changes *how you play*, not only how you look.

HEAVY

More starting mass: more shots, harder to push. Slower.

MASS

SPEED

BALANCED

The reference build every other one is tuned against.

MASS

SPEED

LIGHT

Less starting mass: fewer shots, flies further when hit. Faster.

MASS

SPEED

Weight classes are standard in the genre (e.g. Mario Kart). The twist is that weight is also ammunition. Bars are illustrative; stats are designed after the MVP.

No game we found ties *knockback to lost mass*



LINK	CLOSEST PRIOR ART	STATUS
01 Spend your body	Osmos ejects its own matter to move, not to attack. Agar.io ejects mass.	DIFFERENT USE
02 Hits shrink you	Squarena (2D): lower health, smaller body. Morphies Law: hits move mass between robots.	PRECEDENT
03 Attack costs health	Crisol: Theater of Idols spends your blood as ammo. Not physical mass.	PRECEDENT
04 Lighter, launched further	Not found. Smash Bros. raises knockback with a damage % counter; Squarena's small bodies feel more of their own recoil.	NOT FOUND
01–04 together, in 3D	Not found in any party game we searched.	NOT FOUND

Prior-art search of shipped games, Oct 2026 [9–12]. “Not found” = not found after searching.

Social PC play is growing; *LAN party games are rare*

$43.6B

PC games revenue in 2025, up 12% year on year.

NEWZOO [1]

$4.1B

Steam revenue of games with co-op, H1 2025: an all-time high (estimate).

ALINEA [2]

70%

of US players aged 8+ play with other people.

ESA 2026 [3]

≈8%

of ~3,490 Steam “Party Game” titles list LAN PvP.

STEAM, OCT 2026 [4]



Risk, stated plainly: an estimated 65.9% of 2025 Steam releases earned under $1,000 [5], while 5,863 games passed $100K in 2025 (Valve) [6]. LAN is our differentiator, not a demand driver.

Five games *we are measured against*



Party Animals

Recreate Games · 2023
steam app 1260320

VISUAL

Plush 3D animals, toy-like arenas.

MECHANIC

Physics brawling: grab, punch, throw rivals out.

MULTIPLAYER

Online and same-screen. No LAN listed.

FINANCIALS

Launch peak 104,174. Owner est. 2.5M–6.0M.



Gang Beasts

Boneloaf · 2017
steam app 285900

VISUAL

Soft, gelatinous 3D people.

MECHANIC

Ragdoll brawling into stage hazards.

MULTIPLAYER

Same-screen and online. No LAN listed.

FINANCIALS

85% positive. Owner est. 4.6M–5.8M.



Fall Guys

Mediatonic / Epic · 2020
steam app 1097150

VISUAL

Candy-coloured beans, obstacle courses.

MECHANIC

Short race and survival rounds in a playlist.

MULTIPLAYER

Online, cross-platform only.

FINANCIALS

Free-to-play. Legacy Steam peak 172,213.



Pummel Party

Rebuilt Games · 2018
steam app 880940

VISUAL

Low-poly 3D, slapstick items.

MECHANIC

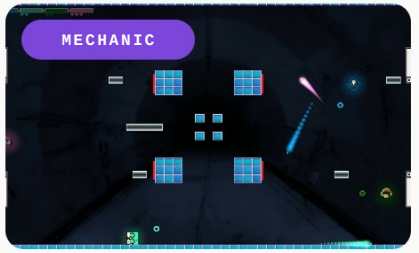
Board game with short mini-games.

MULTIPLAYER

4–8 online and local. No LAN listed.

FINANCIALS

$14.99. Peak 20,957. Owner est. 1.5M–7.6M.



Squarena

Codeaclysm · 2022
steam app 1858400

VISUAL

Minimal flat 2D squares.

MECHANIC

Low health shrinks you; small bodies feel more recoil.

MULTIPLAYER

Up to 6 local. No LAN listed.

FINANCIALS

$4.99. Sales not disclosed.

Screenshots: official Steam media, © publishers. “Owner est.” = third-party estimates via SteamDB, not sales. Data 2026-10-17 [7].

Where we sit *among them*

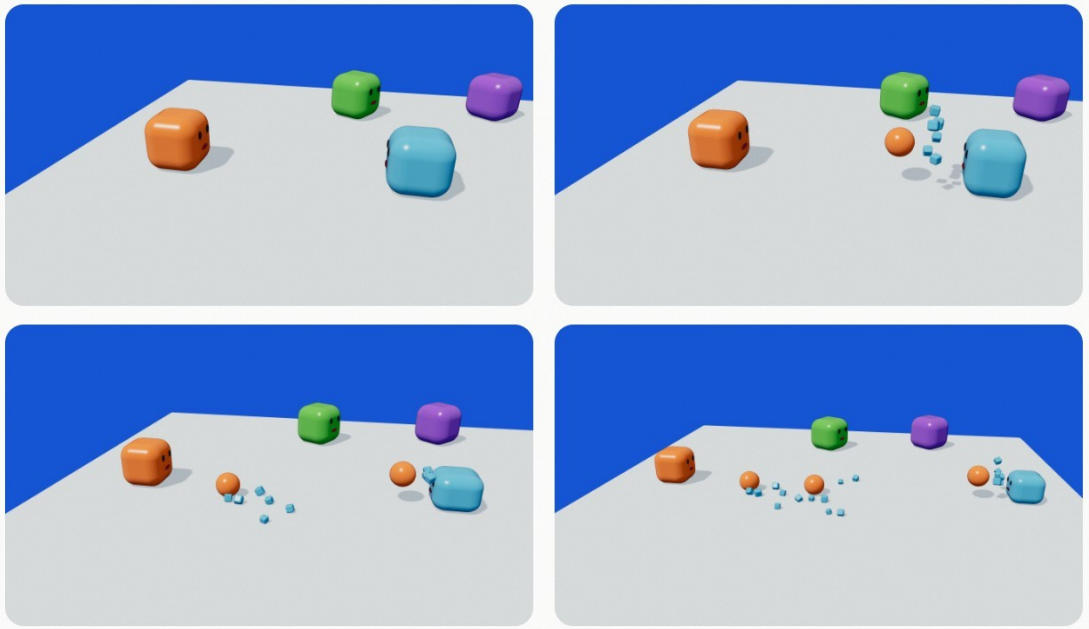
	PARTY ANIMALS	GANG BEASTS	FALL GUYS	PUMMEL PARTY	SQUARENA	ICE RUMBLE
3D characters	●	●	●	●	○	●
Ranged attacks	◐	○	○	◐	●	●
Damage changes your body size	○	○	○	○	●	●
Less mass, further knockback	○	○	○	○	○	●
Several mini-games, one result	○	○	◐	●	○	●
Official LAN play	○	○	○	○	○	●
Plays with no internet	○	●	○	●	●	●

● Yes ◐ Partly ○ No

“Official LAN” = advertised in the game’s Steam features. “Partly”: Party Animals and Pummel Party have some weapons or items; Fall Guys’ playlist eliminates rather than scores. Party Animals needs internet even on one screen [8]. Ice Rumble column = planned design.

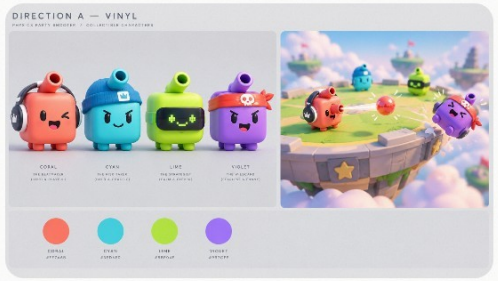
What we have *built and drawn* so far

PHYSICS PROTOTYPE



Three.js, deterministic, rendered frame by frame. Three shots: the target shrinks and is pushed further each time. We used it to check the rule reads before writing Unity code.

ART-DIRECTION DRAFTS



A · VINYL TOY



B · BUILDING BLOCKS



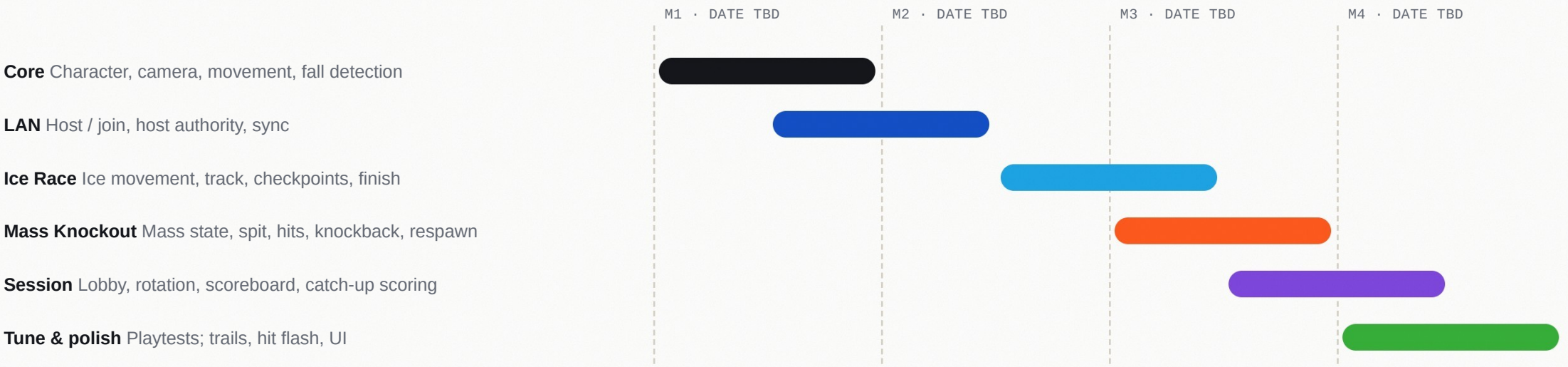
C · TIN TOY



D · JELLY

Four looks for the same cube. This deck uses the glossy-toy direction. All AI-generated; none is gameplay.

Build order: *shared core first*, then each mini-game



RISK: NETWORKED PHYSICS

Clients disagree on a knockback. Host-authoritative simulation; clients only render.

RISK: BALANCE

Stalling or snowballing. Score knockouts; respawn at full mass; catch-up scoring.

RISK: SCOPE

Too many mini-games. Two for the MVP; more only once both are fun.

SUMMARY

Ice Rumble

- 2–4 players, one LAN, no internet.
- Two mini-games on one shared Unity core.
- Every shot costs the shooter mass, so aim matters more than volume.

Questions?

Ezel Bayraktar · Abdurrahim Özağaç · Kürşat Hürkan Aydın · Ardıl Bilal Ülkü



Concept render, AI-generated. Not gameplay.

Sources

[1] Newzoo final 2025 figures, via GameDev Reports, 2026-06-26. gamedevreports.substack.com/p/newzoo-gaming-market-surpassed-200

[2] Alinea Analytics, games with co-op on Steam, H1 2025 (proprietary estimates). alineaanalytics.substack.com/p/games-with-co-op-generated-over-4

[3] ESA Essential Facts 2026 (survey Feb 2026, n=13,545). theesa.com

[4] Steam store search, tag “Party Game” × LAN PvP / Online PvP / Shared-Split-screen PvP, 2026-10-17. Tags are user-applied.

[5] Game Developers, 2025 Steam revenue distribution (Gamalytic estimates), 2026-08-21. game-developers.org/2025-steam-game-revenue-distribution

[6] PC Gamer, Valve at GDC 2026: 5,863 games over $100K on Steam in 2025. pcgamer.com

[7] Steam store pages and SteamDB charts, apps 1260320, 285900, 1097150, 880940, 1858400: prices, peaks, reviews, owner estimates. 2026-10-17.

[8] GameRevolution / Prima Games: Party Animals requires an internet connection, including split-screen.

[9] Osmos official site, osmos-game.com. [10] Squarena on Steam (app 1858400); codeaclysmgames.com/squarena-details.

[11] Morphies Law official site, morphieslaw.com/game. [12] Crisol: Theater of Idols, Blumhouse Games and Steam (app 1790930).

Images: all game visuals are AI concept renders (GPT Image via Higgsfield; MiniMax H3) from our own reference art, except competitor screenshots (official Steam media).